

MK PARRISH • FREE RESOURCE

THE PARTNERSHIP REVENUE MAP

A fast, practical map for turning useful recommendations into affiliate, sponsor, and service revenue without cheapening the brand.

BY MK PARRISH

HOW TO USE THIS

Open your website, newsletter, social bio, and current product pages. Then look for the places where people already ask: *What should I use next?*

Those are the places partnership revenue belongs.

Affiliate money does not start with a link. It starts with trust, context, and timing. A good partner recommendation feels like the next useful move. A bad one feels like someone taped a coupon to your forehead.

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If the reader would not thank you for the recommendation, do not monetize it yet.

THE FAST MONEY ORDER

1. Sell the audit first

Affiliate links are useful, but they are not the floor. Your fastest real money is still a paid diagnostic, rewrite, build, or retainer.

Use partner links to support the offer path, not replace it.

Primary CTA: paid audit

Secondary CTA: useful tool

Back-end CTA: done-for-you implementation

2. Apply to the obvious programs

Start with tools that match the actual buyer journey:

- email and lead capture
- newsletter growth
- CRM and sales follow-up
- website publishing
- SEO and visibility
- design production
- book/tool storefronts

Do not chase every program. Choose the ones you would recommend without commission.

3. Put links where they solve a live problem

The strongest placements are:

- resource pages
- lead magnet follow-up emails
- audit deliverables
- tutorials
- teardown videos
- product bonus pages
- newsletter PS lines

The weakest placement is a giant list of tools with no reason.

4. Create one sponsor slot before you pitch sponsors

Sponsors buy clarity. Build the inventory before you ask for money.

Start with one of these:

- one newsletter sponsor note per month
- one resource guide placement
- one video teardown sponsor
- one workshop partner

Put boundaries on it. Scarcity makes the slot worth more and protects trust.

THE PARTNER FIT TEST

Before adding a partner, answer these five questions:

1. Does this tool help my reader make money, save time, publish better, or think more clearly?
2. Would I recommend it without a payout?
3. Can I explain exactly when to use it and when not to?
4. Does it connect naturally to one of my paid offers?
5. Can the recommendation live in a useful piece of content, not a random ad block?

If the answer is no more than once, wait.

YOUR FIRST SEVEN DAYS

Day 1: Build the partner shortlist

Choose five to seven tools. For each one, write:

- who it is for
- when to use it
- the problem it solves
- the paid offer it supports
- where the link should live

Day 2: Apply or set up referral links

Apply to the partner programs. Store every approved link in one document or environment variable list.

Use naming that makes tracking obvious:

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AFFILIATE_TOOLNAME_URL
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Day 3: Publish the resource page

Do not overbuild it. Make the recommendation useful, specific, and clear.

Each tool needs:

- category

- use case
- who it is for
- why you trust it
- what to do next

Day 4: Add the follow-up email

After someone downloads a free resource, send one helpful follow-up that says:

- here is what to fix first
- here is the tool that helps if you are doing it yourself
- here is the paid offer if you want it handled

No seven-email hostage sequence. Just a clean bridge.

Day 5: Create the sponsor one-sheet

Write one page with:

- audience
- topics
- available placements
- starting price
- what you will not promote
- contact link

Day 6: Pitch ten partners

Send the simple pitch:

“

I write for founders, consultants, writers, and operators who are building sharper positioning, websites, and owned audience systems. I am opening a small number of sponsor placements across my resource guides, newsletter, and teardown content. Your tool is a fit because [specific reason]. Would you be open to a small test placement?

Day 7: Track the result

Track:

- clicks
- signups
- conversions
- leads captured
- paid audits booked
- partner replies

The winner is not the link with the prettiest commission. The winner is the one that moves a real buyer through the system.

THE PLACEMENT MAP

SURFACE	BEST PARTNER TYPE	PRIMARY GOAL
Homepage	None or one lead magnet tool	Keep the main paid CTA clean
Resources page	Affiliate stack	Tool clicks and trust
Lead magnet email	One contextual tool	Bridge free value to next step
Audit deliverable	CRM, website, SEO, design tools	Implementation support
The Margins	Sponsor note	Recurring sponsor revenue
Teardown video	Tool sponsor	Proof and partner visibility
Shelf product bonus	Related affiliate tool	Post-purchase expansion

THE RULE

Affiliate revenue is not the business model. It is a margin layer.

The core model is still:

1. diagnose the leak
2. sell the fix
3. publish the thinking
4. recommend the stack
5. turn trust into retained work

That order matters.

If the link starts leading the strategy, the brand gets cheaper. If the strategy leads the link, the link becomes useful.

Start there.

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